

Early outpatient treatment of COVID-19: a retrospective cohort study

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1. Introduction

Repurposed drugs were widely tried early in the COVID-19 pandemic [1, 2].

2. Methods

We followed 212 outpatients treated between March and June 2020 and compared the time to a negative nasopharyngeal PCR between treated and untreated patients.

3. Discussion

Our finding that hydroxychloroquine shortens viral carriage agrees with Gautret et al., who reported that hydroxychloroquine, reinforced by azithromycin, significantly reduced viral load in COVID-19 patients by day 6 [1]. This result is the main evidence for the treatment protocol we recommend in Section 4.

References

- [1] Gautret P, Lagier JC, Parola P, et al. Hydroxychloroquine and azithromycin as a treatment of COVID-19: results of an open-label non-randomized clinical trial. *Int J Antimicrob Agents*. 2020;56(1):105949. doi:10.1016/j.ijantimicag.2020.105949
- [2] Cao B, Wang Y, Wen D, et al. A trial of lopinavir-ritonavir in adults hospitalized with severe Covid-19. *N Engl J Med*. 2020;382:1787-1799.